Republic of the Philippines
Bicol University
BICOL UNIVERSITY OTAKU CIRCLE
Academic Year 2026 – 2027
Legazpi City, Albay

CONSTITUTION AND BY LAWS

Article I
NAME AND NATURE

Section 1.

This organization shall be officially known as the Bicol University Otaku Circle. Hereinafter, the organization shall be referred to as the BU Otaku Circle or BUOC.

Section 2.

"Otaku" is a Japanese term referring to "geek" or "nerd" but it is typically used to refer to a fan of anime, video games or Japanese Culture in general. Thus, Bicol University Otaku Circle is a University Based Organization established by Otaku students of Bicol University.

Section 3.

The Bicol University Otaku Circle caters to those who are anime and cosplay enthusiasts, photographers and videographers, traditional and digital artists, online and offline gamers, and everything else in the spectrum; hence the name Otaku Circle.

Article II
OBJECTIVES

Section 1.

General Objective: "To promote Otaku and Japanese Culture to the students of Bicol University, and to be able to flourish the extra-curricular engagement of the students."

Section 2.

Specific Objectives:

1) To bridge the academic excellence of Bicol University to the students.
2) To foster unity and camaraderie among members of Otaku Circle.
3) To serve as a training ground for its members to become academically and socially competitive.
4) To be able to provide a creative and technical platform to enhance a student's creativity and establish relations with other students that have similar advocacies and interests.

Article III
DECLARATION OF ORGANIZATION'S PRINCIPLES

Section 1.

The organization encourages nationalism and youth involvement on public and civic affairs.

Section 2.

The organization shall maintain honesty and integrity in the public service.

Section 3.

The organization shall pursue non-partisan objectives, programs, and undertakings.

Section 4.
The organization believes that an Otaku BUeño is capable of excellence in various fields.

Article IV
MEMBERSHIP

Section 1.
The Bicol University Otaku Circle is a University Based Organization whose members are bona-fide students of the Bicol University (Undergraduates and Graduate School).

Section 2.
Nature of Application:
1) Application is voluntary and shall be open every academic year.
2) Applicants must be officially enrolled in Bicol University.
3) Application period shall run for the first and second semester of the academic year, applicants are required to attend all activities of the organization and provide a membership fee amounting to Php 100.00 for the whole academic year consisting of Php 50.00 per semester with the following benefit: An official BUOC enamel membership pin, provided that there are sufficient funds to support production and distribution.
4) All students from Bicol University are qualified to join upon the completion of the application requirements prescribed by the organization.
5) Applicants shall be evaluated according to the performance and depending on the criteria set by the PR-HR Committee.
6) The PR-HR Committee, together with the Executive Committee, shall decide on the final list of applicants qualified for induction.

Section 3.
There shall be five standing committees: The Secretariat Committee, the Finance Committee, the Planning Committee, the PR-HR Committee and the Ways and Means Committee.

Section 4.
The PR-HR Committee shall distribute off members to their respective committees at the start of every academic year based on:

1) For old members:
a) Member's committee preference.
b) Participation and fulfillment of the member's duties as stated in Article V, Section 2 of this constitution, in the previous academic year.

2) For new members:
a) Member's committee preference.
b) Performance in the approaches reflected by the scores accumulated in the course of the application period.

Section 5.
Renewal of membership shall be held annually.

Section 6.

The following membership statuses are herein adapted:

1) Active Members shall be those that satisfy Sections 1 and 3 of these articles and continuously perform their duties. They have full right as in Article V.
2) Inactive Members shall be those who satisfy the sections 1 and 3 of these articles but for certain reasons, clearly justified before the PR-HR and Executive Committees, cannot participate in at least 60% of the total activities of the organization.
3) Probationary Members shall be those who fail to attend the Final Rites and Induction but otherwise satisfy the requirements set by the PR-HR Committee during the application period.
4) Honorary Members shall be those who shall be conferred with this honor by the General Assembly on the account of their significant contributions and services to the organization.
5) Alumni Members shall be members of the organization who have graduated.

Article V
RIGHTS AND DUTIES OF MEMBERS

Section 1.

The members of the organization shall have the following rights:

1) The right to co-ordinate activities or participate in the activities of the organization.
2) The right to use any of the organization's facilities and materials, provided that the president gave the consent.
3) The right to choose a committee and actively participate in it.
4) The right to vote and to be voted upon.
5) The right to run for office provided that he/she is qualified as stated in Article VII of this constitution.
6) The right to recommend suspension or impeachment of a member or officer.
7) The right to speak out and be heard in the General Assembly.
8) The right to suggest projects or any other necessary actions that would help the improvement of the organization.
9) The right to be formally notified, heard, and adjudicated by the General Assembly before being suspended or expelled.
10) The right to defend his/her actions when in question.

Section 2.

The members of the organization shall have the following duties:

1) Abide by and uphold the Bicol University Otaku Circle Constitution.
2) Know his/her rights and duties as a member and understand the principles of the organization.
3) Fulfill all duties that may be entrusted to him/her by the organization.
4) Maintain peace and order within the organization, and refrain from any action that may be detrimental to the organization.
5) Participate in at least 60% of the activities of the organization.
6) Can be a volunteer to one committee per academic year.
7) Dutifully participate and attend the meetings of his/her committee.
8) Maintain and improve the facilities of the organization.
9) Respect all decisions of the organization that are agreed upon in the General Assembly.
10) Accomplish his/her financial obligations in time.

11) Attend at least 60% of all the General Assemblies of the organization, except for members who can present a valid reason before the Executive Committee.

Article VI
ORGANIZATIONAL STRUCTURE

Section 1.

There shall be a General Assembly composed of all members of the organization. The assembly shall determine all policies and decisions of the organization, except for those which had been already specified.

Section 2.

There shall be an Executive Committee composed of the President/Chairperson, Internal Vice President, External Vice President, Secretary General, Deputy Secretary General, Finance General, Deputy Finance General, Auditor, The Business Managers, Public Information Officer, Chief Campus Representatives, and Deputy Campus Representatives.

Section 3.

There shall be five standing committees: The Secretariat Committee, the Finance Committee, the Planning Committee, the PR-HR Committee and the Ways and Means Committee.

Section 4.

Ad Hoc Committees shall be created by the Executive Committee and shall perform special functions not covered by the committees mentioned in Section 3 of this Article. However, once the function of the Ad Hoc Committee is done, the committee shall be dissolved.

Article VII
QUALIFICATIONS FOR OFFICERS

Section 1.

All active members are qualified to run for office in the organization provided that they satisfy Article IV, Sections 1 and 3.

Section 2.

The President shall:

1) Have at least three (3) consecutive semesters of active membership in the organization prior to his/her term.
2) Can hold top position in any other organization, whether university-based or college-based, during his/her term providing he/she will do his/her obligations and responsibilities in the organization prior to his/her term.
3) Not have been subjected to any disciplinary action by the university.

Section 3.

The Vice-Presidents shall have at least two (2) consecutive semesters of active membership in the organization prior to their term and shall not have been subjected to any disciplinary action by the university.

Section 4.

All other officers shall be active members of the organization and shall not have been subjected to any disciplinary action by the university.

Article VIII
OFFICER'S RESPONSIBILITIES

Section 1.

The responsibilities of the President/Chairperson are as follows:

1) He/she is the head of the Executive Committee.
2) He/She shall approve, facilitate and supervise meetings, projects and activities of the organization.
3) He/she shall resolve conflicts regarding the Executive Committee.
4) He/She shall represent and bear the organization's name in formal events, meetings and activities.
5) He/She shall carry out and implement policies and constitution amendments approved by the General Assembly.
6) He/She shall take charge with the over-all supervision of the standing committees.
7) He/She shall create Ad hoc committee in cases it is deemed necessary.

Section 2.

The responsibilities of the Internal Vice President are as follows:

1) He/she shall serve as the Officer-In-Charge in case the President is not available.
2) He/she shall facilitate internal activities like acquaintance parties and other bonding activities of the organization.
3) He/she shall be a co-head of the Planning Committee.
4) He/she shall assist the President in all matters where his presence is required.

Section 3.

The responsibilities of the External Vice President are as follows:

1) He/she shall serve as the Officer-In-Charge in case the President is not available.
2) He/she shall supervise all external activities like council meetings of the University, and other related activities.
3) He/She shall be a co-head of the Planning Committee.
4) He/she shall represent and bear the organization's name in formal events, meetings and activities in cases that the President is not available.

Section 4.

The responsibilities of the Secretary General are as follows:

1) He/she is the head of the Secretariat Committee.
2) He/she shall handle all records and files of the organization.
3) He/she shall prepare all the Accomplishment Reports of the organization and present them at the end of the semester.
4) He/she shall evaluate project proposals planned by the organization.
5) He/she shall record and keep the minutes of every meeting.

Section 5.

The responsibilities of the Deputy Secretary General are as follows:

1) He/she is the co-head of the Secretariat Committee.
2) He/she shall help the Secretary General handle all records and files of the organization.
3) He/she shall help the Secretary General prepare all the Accomplishment Reports of the organization and present them at the end of the semester.
4) He/she shall help the Secretary General evaluate project proposals planned by the organization.

Section 6.

The responsibilities of the Finance General are as follows:

1) He/she is the head of the Finance Committee.
2) He/she shall prepare all the Finance Reports of the organization and present them at the end of the semester.
3) He/she shall evaluate budgetary proposals planned by the organization.
4) He/she shall act as the custodian of funds of the Organization.

Section 7.

The responsibilities of the Deputy Finance General are as follows:

1) He/she is the co-head of the Finance Committee.
2) He/she shall help the finance officer prepare all the Finance Reports of the organization and present them at the end of the semester.
3) He/she shall help the Finance officer evaluate budgetary proposals planned by the organization.

Section 8.

The Responsibilities of the Auditor are as follows:

1) He/she shall ensure the compliance with established internal control procedures by examining records, reports, operating practices and documentation.
2) He/she shall audit the financial and accomplishment reports provided by the secretariat and finance committee.

Section 9.

The Responsibilities of the Business Managers are as follows:

1) They shall allocate resources to accomplish desired goals and objectives efficiently and effectively.
2) They shall be the heads of the Ways and Means Committee.
3) They shall act as property custodian give consent to such member(s) utilization of any of the organization's facilities and materials.

Section 10.

The responsibilities of the Public Information Officer are as follows:

1) He/she shall be the head of the PR-HR committee.
2) He/she shall plan publicity strategies and campaigns, and deal with the inquiries of the public.
3) He/she shall serve as the official spokesperson in behalf of the organization.

Section 11.

The responsibilities of the Chief Campus Representatives and Deputy Campus Representatives are as follows:

1) They shall represent the organization in their respective campuses (Main, Daraga, East).
2) They shall assist the Executive Committee in coordinating and implementing campus-specific activities.

Article IX
STANDING COMMITTEES

Section 1.

The Secretariat Committee shall have the following functions:

1) Assist the Secretary General and the Deputy Secretary General perform his/her duties.
2) Take charge of the documents and records of the organization.
3) Help disseminate information to all other members of the organization.
4) The Secretary General shall be the head of the Secretariat Committee, and the Deputy Secretary General being the co-head.

Section 2.

The Finance Committee shall have the following functions:

1) Be responsible for the organization's finance.
2) Initiate fund-raising projects for the organization.
3) Collect dues and fees from the applicants and members of the organization.
4) See to it that the organization's finances are used for the welfare and benefit of the members and the organization itself.
5) The Finance General shall be the head of the Finance Committee, and the Deputy Finance General being the co-head.

Section 3.

The PR-HR Committee shall have the following functions:

1) Be in charge of the application process.
2) Together with the Executive Committee evaluate the status of members every semester and decide on probation cases.
3) Screen and evaluate applicants for membership along with the Executive Committee.
4) Supervise the reaffirmation process of the members.
5) Initiate activities that foster camaraderie, cooperation, solidarity, and unity among the applicants and members.
6) Formulate and implement application guidelines, requirements, procedures, provided that the Executive Committee approves.
7) Help disseminate information to all other members of the organization.
8) Secure and store a copy of the constitution and by-laws.
9) The Public Information Officer shall be the head of the PR-HR Committee.

Section 4.

The Ways and Means Committee shall have the following functions:

1) To use funds entrusted to the club for such purposes as will.
2) Be concerned with tall matters associated with raising the organization's funds.
3) The Business Managers shall be the heads of the Ways and Means Committee.

Section 5.

The Planning Committee shall have the following functions:

1) To assist in the formulation, supervising, and execution of plans, projects and other endeavors of the organization.
2) To work alongside with the Secretariat and Executive Committee in the creation and preparation of the mandatory foundations of events and activities that shall be facilitated by the organization.
3) The External Vice President and the Internal Vice President shall be the co-heads of the Planning Committee.

Article X
GENERAL ASSEMBLY

Section 1.
The General Assembly is the highest policy making body of the organization and shall have the final authority in any activities of the organization.

Section 2.
The General Assembly shall be composed of all members of the organization.

Section 3.
The General Assembly shall have the following powers:
1) Elect the members of the Executive Committee.
2) Exercise the final authority on matters affecting the organization.
3) Amend the Constitution and other policies upon approval of the majority.
4) Take the decision on the expulsion of a member.
5) Suspend or impeach any member of the Executive Committee, upon the approval of 75% of the voting body.

Section 4.
The General Assembly shall be held twice in every semester.

Article XI
ELECTIONS

Section 1.
Nominations for officers shall be held during the first general assembly of the organization facilitated by the incumbent officers.

Section 2.
The schedule for the election of new officers and the first general assembly shall be set by the Executive Committee.

Section 3.
The nomination and election of officers shall be supervised and facilitated by the Executive Committee.

Section 4.
Election of officers shall be conducted through casting of votes.

Section 5.
Only active members are allowed to nominate and vote.

Section 6.
Incumbent officers may be reelected once for the same office.

Section 7.
All elected officers shall have tenure of one (1) academic year.

Section 8.
The new set of duly elected officers shall resume office a day after the election on the first semester of the academic year and will end at the start of the first semester of the following academic year.

Section 9.
A candidate is proclaimed winner if he/she gets at least fifty percent plus one (50% + 1) of the votes cast. If no candidate satisfies the condition, the top two (2) candidates shall vile for the position again.

Section 10.
The Executive Committee shall do a temporary appointment immediately, on case of permanent vacation of an elected officer.

Article XII
LOSS OF MEMBERSHIP

Section 1.
Expulsion is the permanent loss of membership from the organization. Expelled members cannot be readmitted to the organization.

Section 2.
The following are grounds for expulsion:
1) Incurrence of three (3) or more violations or offenses within a semester, as stated in Section 3 of this Article.
2) Non-attendance in all General Assemblies.
3) Gross violation of the Constitution.
4) Commissions on acts highly detrimental to the interest, integrity, and well-being of the organization.

Section 3.
Each of the following shall be considered a violation:
1) Three (3) unexcused consecutive absences from the General Assembly.
2) Non-participation in at least 60% of all the activities of the organization.
3) Unreasonable neglect of duty entrusted by the organization.
4) Commission of acts detrimental to the interest, integrity, and well-being of the organization.

5) Non-payment of financial obligations on time.
6) Destruction of the organization's facilities.

Section 4.
Any member shall lose his/her membership if he/she fails to renew or if he/she withdraws his/her membership.

Article XIII
FACULTY ADVISER

Section 1.
The organization shall have one (1) Faculty Adviser duly elected every year by the active members.

Section 2.
The Faculty Adviser shall advice and guide the organization regarding the activities.

Section 3.
There is no limit to the number of times the Faculty Adviser may be chosen.

Article XIV
NO HAZING POLICY

Section 1.
The organization strongly opposes hazing or any violent acts that may endanger the lives of the applicants during the application process.

Section 2.
Those who will violate this act shall automatically be terminated from the organization.

Article XV
NO USING OF ILLEGAL DRUGS POLICY

Section 1.
The organization strongly opposes the use of illegal drugs that may endanger the lives of its members and applicants.

Section 2.
Those who will violate this act shall be automatically terminated from the organization.

Article XVI
AMENDMENTS

Section 1.

Amendments of this Constitution may be proposed by a member, provided it is first endorsed in writing by at least five (5) active members to the Executive Committee not later than three (3) days before the General Assembly wherein it will be formally presented. Those members proposing the amendment are charged with the responsibility of making sure that all active members are aware of the content of the proposed amendment.

Section 2.

The amendment shall be adapted upon arrival of two- thirds (2/3) of all the active members present during the said General Assembly. No amendment shall be acted upon without prior notice to all active members.

We, the members of this organization, do hereby swear unto this constitution. With our policies and principles, this constitution is a manifestation of our primary objectives and purpose. This Constitution is presented for the members of the organization to accept and abide by, so hereby promulgated:

CERTIFIED TRUE AND CORRECT

Prepared By:

KICHI YZ M. LOZANO
Secretary General

Attested By:

IRA SHAIN A. CAÑAVERAL
President/Chairperson

Members of the body:

TRAVIS B. BRIOSO
Internal Vice President

KIMBERLY SUZANNE H. NOBLE
External Vice President

AVILA JHON SIMIUON
Deputy Secretary General

MA. VICENTA V. CABIGAO
Finance General

NATHANIEL M. LUCASIA
Deputy Finance General

NHEIL RAMMSTEIN R. VISAYAS
Auditor

DARLENE KEISHA MARIN. LOBETE

JESTHER A. MILLETE

KEAN FRANCE ALTHEA M. ARGANA

Business Managers

VIRGED D. JAO
Public Information Officer

RESHA MARIE S. LUNA

LYN ROSE N. MANUEL

NHEIL RAMMSTEIN R. VISAYAS

Chief Campus Representatives

AUBREY ROSE B. BORILLO

JEMIMA RUBY G. BITANCOR

RINKA CHELSEA GABRIELLE A. CRESENCIO

Deputy Campus Representatives

Noted:

PROF. MARIA TEODORA A. LOÑOSA
Bicol University Otaku Circle, Advisor